

Cryptocurrency data typically includes:

- **Price Data:** Similar to stock OHLCV data
- **Market Cap:** The total value of all coins in circulation
- **Trading Volume:** Often separated by exchange
- **Blockchain Data:** Unique to cryptocurrencies, including transaction counts and network metrics

What makes cryptocurrency data special is its 24/7 availability and the transparency of blockchain transactions, which provides algorithmic traders with additional dimensions for analysis not available in traditional markets.

Alternative Data: The Secret Weapons

Beyond traditional market data, sophisticated algorithmic traders increasingly use "alternative data"—novel information sources that might provide trading edges:

- **Satellite Imagery:** Counting cars in retail parking lots to predict sales
- **Social Media Sentiment:** Analyzing Twitter or Reddit for market sentiment
- **Credit Card Transactions:** Aggregated spending patterns to forecast consumer companies' earnings
- **Weather Data:** Predicting agricultural commodity prices based on weather patterns

While these alternative data sources are beyond the scope of this chapter, they represent the cutting edge of algorithmic trading, where the first firms to effectively incorporate new data sources can gain significant advantages.

Fetching Financial Data with Python